Northwestern University
CIERA: Center for Interdiscplinary
Exploration and Research in Astrophysics
1800 Sherman Ave., Evanston, IL 60201
https://jamesjohnson.space

James W. Johnson
Curriculum Vitae

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Academic Positions

Northwestern University — Evanston, Illinois

2026 – Present **LSST-DA DSFP Postdoctoral Associate**
Center for Interdisplinary Exploration and Research in Astrophysics (CIERA)
Supervisor: Prof. Adam A. Miller

Carnegie Institution of Washington – The Observatories — Pasadena, California

2023 – 2026 **Postdoctoral Fellow**
Carnegie Theoretical Astrophysics Center
Supervisor: Dr. Ana Bonaca

Education

August 2023 **Ph.D. in Astronomy**
The Ohio State University — Columbus, Ohio
Dissertation Advisor: Prof. David H. Weinberg
Committee: Prof. Jennifer A. Johnson, Prof. Christopher S. Kochanek
From Dwarfs to Spirals: Chemical Evolution of Galaxies across Stellar Mass and the Implications for Nucleosynthesis

May 2021 **M.S. in Astronomy**
The Ohio State University — Columbus, Ohio

May 2017 **B.S. in Physics**, Minor in Astronomy, *Cum Laude*
Vanderbilt University — Nashville, Tennessee
Highest Honors in Astronomy, Thesis Advisor: Prof. Andreas A. Berlind

Research

39	14	25	1,300+	19
Journal Publications	**1st & 2nd Author**	**Contributing Author**	**Citations**	**H-Index**

Interests

Galactic chemical evolution – The Milky Way – Dwarf galaxies – The astrophysical origin of the elements – Big Bang nucleosynthesis – Near field cosmology – Astronomical software

Science Explorer Libraries (A full list of my journal publications is included.)

All My Papers https://scixplorer.org/public-libraries/rIqfpNKmSdaOMIAhkk2VzQ
1st & 2nd Author https://scixplorer.org/public-libraries/go1WSseGTMeft2SxdESAgw
Co-Author https://scixplorer.org/public-libraries/sZkjSf_XRSKSRykqBe6B_w

Astrophysical Software Development

Versatile Integrator for Chemical Evolution (VICE)
Lead developer and license owner (Spring 2018 – Present)
Documentation: https://vice-astro.readthedocs.io
Source Code: https://github.com/giganano/VICE.git
Install: https://pypi.org/project/vice

Observing Programs

PI: *The First Extragalactic Measure of the Helium Isotopic Ratio – A New Test of Fundamental Physics*
Clay 6.5-m Telescope, Las Campanas Observatory
2024B WINERED spectrograph, 18 hours
2025A MIKE spectrograph, 6 hours

Invited Talks

2026 **Everything FLOWS** Conference
University of Groningen (Groningen, The Netherlands)
2026 **APOGEE's Galactic Odyssey** Conference
Centro de Estudios de Fisica del Cosmos de Aragón (Teruel, Spain)
2026 **Galactic Metal Cycles** Conference
University of Notre Dame (Kylemore Abbey, Ireland)
2025 **University of California, Davis** (Davis, California) Seminar
2025 **Stockholms Universitet** (Stockholm, Sweden) Seminar
2025 **Uppsala Universitet** (Uppsala, Sweden) Seminar
2024 **DHWFEST** Conference
University of Utah (Salt Lake City, Utah)
2024 **Lund University** (Lund, Sweden) Seminar
2019 **University of California, Santa Cruz** (Santa Cruz, CA) Seminar

Conference Presentations

SDSS Collaboration Meeting
2026 Katholieke Universiteit Leuven (Leuven, Belgium)
2025 Max Planck Institut für Astronomie (Heidelberg, Germany)
2024 New Mexico State University (Las Cruces, NM)
2024 **ADONIS: Abundance Gradients in the Local Universe**
Munich Institute for Astro-, Particle, and BioPhysics (MIAPbP; Munich, Germany)
2023 **Surveying the Milky Way: The Universe in Our Own Backyard**
California Institute of Technology (Pasadena, CA)
2023 **241st American Astronomical Society Meeting** (Dissertation Talk)
Seattle, Washington Convention Center
2021 **GALAH Science Meeting** (Virtual)
2020, 2021 **SDSS Collaboration Meeting** (Virtual)

Posters

2024 **Small Galaxies, Cosmic Questions – II**, Durham University (Durham, England)
2020 **236th American Astronomical Society Meeting** (virtual)

Honors & Awards

2023 **CTAC Postdoctoral Fellowship**, Carnegie Science
2022 **Ann S. Tuttle Paper Prize**, Ohio State, Dept. of Astronomy
Annual award to the top graduate student-led publication of the previous year
Johnson J.W., et al., 2021, MNRAS, 508, 4484 (arxiv:2103.09838)

2022 – 2023	**Presidential Fellowship**, Ohio State, College of Arts & Sciences Financial support for final-year graduate students
2017 – 2018	**University Fellowship**, Ohio State, College of Arts & Sciences Financial support for first-year graduate students
2017	**Larry Ross Cathey Award**, Vanderbilt, Dept. of Physics & Astronomy Outstanding graduating senior studying astronomy
Inducted 2015	**Sigma Pi Sigma Physics National Honor Society**, Vanderbilt Chapter
7 of 8 semesters	**Dean's List**, Vanderbilt, College of Arts & Sciences

Mentorship

Graduate

2021 – Present	**Liam Dubay** (near-peer mentor; arxiv:2404.08509, 2508.00988, 2608.26261) The Ohio State University, Department of Astronomy Projects: Galactic chemical evolution in the Milky Way
2024 – 2025	**Rayna Rampalli** (primary research contact for arxiv:2509.03577) Dartmouth College, Department of Physics and Astronomy Project: Used solar twins data to uncover relationship between supernova yields and element condensation temperatures
2021 – 2023	**Miqaela Weller** (near-peer mentor; arxiv:2404.08765) The Ohio State University, Department of Astronomy Projects: Investigating the astrophysical origin of helium

Undergraduate

2026 – Present	**Trevor Weiss** California State University Long Beach, Department of Physics & Astronomy Project: Archaeology of Halo Substructures with Asteroseismic Stellar Ages Now: Ph.D. Student at New Mexico State Univeristy
2025 – Present	**Christopher Giudice** San Francisco State University, Department of Physics & Astronomy Cal-Bridge Summer Research Program Project: The Chemical Equilibration Timescale of the Milky Way Disk Now: M.Sc. student at California State University, Long Beach
2022 – 2026	**Daniel Boyea** (primary research contact for honors thesis – arxiv:2511.20752) The Ohio State University, Department of Astronomy Project: Investigating the astrophysical origin of carbon Now: Ph.D. student at University of Groningen, The Netherlands
2024 – 2025	**Damien Tessmer** San Diego State University, Department of Astronomy Cal-Bridge Summer Research Program Project: Identifying trends in stellar nucleosynthesis with SDSS-V data
2022 – 2023	**Lindsey Stultz** The Ohio State University, Department of Physics Polaris Near-Peer Mentorship Program

Teaching

LSST Discovery Alliance (LSST-DA) Data Science Fellowship Program (DSFP)

https://lsstdiscoveryalliance.org/lsst-discovery-alliance-programs/data-science-fellowship/

Supplements graduate eduction in astronomy by teaching essential skills for dealing with the large data set soon to be produced by the Legacy Survey of Space and Time (LSST). Three week-long sessions per year focused on single topic: machine learning, data visualization, time-series analysis, data visualization, software development, big data. Duties: Budget management, site planning, admissions, curriculum development, student communication, instructor recruitment.

Undergraduate Python Coding Workshop

Program Creator, six sessions, ∼25 hours of instruction and exercises
Website: https://jamesjohnson.space/bootcamp
Source material: https://github.com/giganano/PythonBootcamp

2020 – 2023 **Full program (annually)**: Summer undergraduate research students
The Ohio State University, Dept. of Astronomy

2022 **Full program**: 1st- & 2nd-year graduate students
The Ohio State University, Dept. of Astronomy

2024 **Select sessions**: CASSI & Cal-Bridge undergraduate research students
Carnegie Science Observatories

The Ohio State University, Department of Astronomy: Graduate Teaching Assistant

2018 – 2020	**Astronomy 1101: From Planets to Cosmos**	5 sections
2019	**Astronomy 1142: Black Holes**	1 section
2019	**Astronomy 1221: Astronomy Data Analysis**	1 section
2018	**Astronomy 1140: Planets and the Solar System**	1 section

Service & Outreach

2022 – Present **Manuscript Referee**: ApJ, MNRAS, PASJ, A&A (8 manuscripts total)

2026 **Skylark Speaker**, Orange Coast College Planetarium (Costa Mesa, CA)
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GbEMp2_cwfw

2024 – 2026 **Working Group Co-Chair**, Galactic Genesis, SDSS-V

2024 – 2026 **"Morning Tea" co-organizer** (daily arXiv discussion), Carnegie Science

2024 – 2026 **Cal-Bridge Summer Research Program**, Research Mentor (2 students)

2024 – 2025 **External Panelist**, Hubble Space Telescope Proposal Review, Cycles 32 & 33

2024 **Advancing Inclusive Mentoring**, Carnegie Science
12+ hours of instruction and discussion on equitable mentorship practices

2023 **Carnegie Observatories Open House**, Pasadena, CA
100th Anniversary of Edwin Hubble's "VAR!" plate

2021 – 2023 **"Galaxy Hour" meeting organizer**, Ohio State, Dept. of Astronomy

2017 – 2023 **Diversity Journal Club**, Ohio State, Dept. of Astronomy

June 2020 **Real Scientists Germany Online Outreach**
Blog: https://tinyurl.com/jamesjohnsonrealscientistsDE (in German)
Twitter: https://twitter.com/realsci_DE (in German)

2018 – 2020 **Friends of Ohio State Astronomy & Astrophysics**
Lunch with an astronomer

Polaris Near-Peer Mentorship Program

Graduate student-led organization at Ohio State dedicated to fostering a more inclusive environment and improving retention of underrepresented minority groups in the Dept. of Physics and the Dept. of Astronomy. Website: https://u.osu.edu/polaris.

2022 – 2023 **Leadership Committee**

2022 **Academic Facilitator**, Undergraduate Residential Summer Access Program
Early-arrival program for first-year undergraduate students

2022 – 2023 **Near-Peer Mentor** (1 first-year undergraduate student)

Journal Publications

First & Second Author (reverse chronological order)

1. *Towards a measurement of the primordial helium isotope ratio*
   Cooke R.J., **Johnson J.W.**, Noterdaeme P, Pettini M., Welsh L., Wong A., Peroux C.
   2026, ApJ, 1003, 225 – 240 arxiv:2605.00122

2. *The galactic chemical evolution of carbon: Implications for stellar nucleosynthesis*
   Boyea D.A., **Johnson J.W.**, Weinberg D.H.
   2026, MNRAS, 550, 1155 – 1174 arxiv:2511.20752

3. *Metals versus Non-Metals: Chemical Evolution of Hydrogen and Helium Isotopes in the Milky Way*
   Johnson J.W., Weller M.K., Cooke R.J.
   2025, submitted to AAS Journals, under peer review arxiv:2510.08689

4. *That's so Retro: The Gaia-Sausage-Enceladus Merger Trajectory as the Origin of the Chemical Abundance Bimodality in the Milky Way Disk*
   Johnson J.W., Feuillet D.K., Bonaca A., de Brito Silva D.
   2025, accepted for publication in AAS Journals arxiv:2510.08688

5. *Constraints on Radial Gas Flows in the Milky Way Disk Revealed by Large Stellar Age Catalogs*
   Johnson J.W.
   2025, accepted for publication in AAS Journals arxiv:2510.05223

6. *A Galactic Perspective on the (Unremarkable) Relative Refactory Depletion Observed in the Sun*
   Rampalli R., **Johnson J.W.**, Ness M.K., Edwards G.H., Newton E.R., Griffith E.J., Bedell M., Wang K.
   2025, ApJ, 1002, 127 – 147 arxiv:2509.03577

7. *Rising from the Ashes II: The Bar-driven Abundance Bimodality in the Milky Way*
   Beane A., **Johnson J.W.**, Semenov V., Hernquist L., Chandra V., Conroy C.
   2024, ApJ, 985, 221 – 233 arxiv:2410.21580

8. *The Milky Way Radial Metallicity Gradient as an Equilibrium Phenomenon: Why Old Stars are Metal-Rich*
   Johnson J.W., et al.
   2024, ApJ, 988, 8 – 35 arxiv:2410.13256

9. *Dwarf galaxy archaeology from chemical abundances and star formation histories*
   Johnson J.W., et al.
   2023, MNRAS, 526, 5084 – 5109 arxiv:2210.01816

10. *Binaries drive high Type Ia supernova rates in dwarf galaxies*
    Johnson J.W., Kochanek C.S., Stanek K.Z.
    2023, MNRAS, 526, 5911 – 5918 arxiv:2210.01818

11. *Empirical constraints on the nucleosynthesis of nitrogen*
    Johnson J.W., Weinberg D.H., Vincenzo F., Bird J.C., Griffith E.J.
    2023, MNRAS, 520, 782 – 803 arxiv:2202.04666

12. *Stellar migration and chemical enrichment in the Milky Way disc: a hybrid model*
    Johnson J.W., et al.
    2021, MNRAS, 508, 4484 – 4511 arxiv:2103.09838

13. *The impact of starbursts on element abundance ratios*
    Johnson J.W., Weinberg D.H.
    2020, MNRAS, 498, 1364 – 1381 arxiv:1911.02598

14. *The secondary spin bias of dark matter haloes*
    Johnson J.W., Maller A.H., Berlind A.A., Sinha M., Holley-Bockelmann J.K.
    2019, MNRAS, 486, 1156 – 1166 arxiv:1812.02206

Contributing Author (reverse chronological order)

1. *A Broken Clock is Right Twice a Day: [Ce/Mg] is not a Universal Chemical Clock*
   Dubay L.O., et al., incl. **Johnson J.W.**
   2026, submitted to AAS Journals, under peer review arxiv:2608.26261

2. *The Twentieth Data Release of the Sloan Digital Sky Survey: First All-Sky BOSS Spectra, eROSITA-SDSS-V Mapper Coordinated Observations, and a Preview of the Local Volume Mapper*
   SDSS Collaboration, et al., incl. **Johnson J.W.**
   2026, submitted to AAS Journals, under peer review arxiv:2607.26149

3. *Milky Way Mapper Decoded Abundances II: From patterns to paths*
   Ness M.K., et al., incl. **Johnson J.W.**
   2026, MNRAS, 550, 960 – 976 arxiv:2605.21735

4. *Milky Way Mapper Decoded Abundances I: Shared disk enrichment patterns*
   Ness M.K., et al., incl. **Johnson J.W.**
   2026, MNRAS, 548, 637 – 656 arxiv:2605.20487

5. *Scylla at APOGEE: The Impact of Starbursts on the Chemical Evolution of the Magellanic Clouds*
   Escala I., et al., incl. **Johnson J.W.**
   2026, ApJ, 1003, 237 – 263 arxiv:2603.25909

6. *[C/N] Ages for Red Giants and their Implications for Galactic Archaeology*
   Roberts J.D., Pinsonneault M.H., Johnson J.A. Dubay L.O., **Johnson J.W.**
   2025, ApJ, 1002, 191 – 206 arxiv:2509.25321

7. *Challenges to the Two-Infall Scenario by Large Stellar Age Catalogs*
   Dubay L.O., Johnson J.A., **Johnson J.W.**, Roberts J.D.
   2025, ApJ, 1000, 244 – 262 arxiv:2508.00988

8. *The Open Cluster Chemical Abundances and Mapping Survey: VIII. Galactic Chemical Gradient and Azimuthal Analysis from SDSS/MWM DR19*
   Otto J.M., et al., incl. **Johnson J.W.**
   2025, AJ, 171, 91 – 117 arxiv:2507.07264

9. *The Nineteenth Data Release of the Sloan Digital Sky Survey*
   SDSS Collaboration, et al., incl. **Johnson J.W.**
   2025, ApJS, 285, 9 – 47 arxiv:2507.07093

10. *Sloan Digital Sky Survey-V: Pioneering Panoptic Spectroscopy*
    Kollmeier J.A., et al., incl. **Johnson J.W.**
    2025, AJ, 171, 52 – 97 arxiv:2507.06989

11. *Many Elements Matter: Detailed Abundance Patterns Reveal Star-formation and Enrichment Differences among Milky Way Structural Components*
    Griffith E.J., Hogg D.W., Hasselquist S., **Johnson J.W.**, Price-Whelan A., Sit T., Stone-Martinez A., Weinberg D.H.
    2024, ApJ, 169, 280 – 297 arxiv:2410.22121

12. *Modeling the Galactic Chemical Evolution of Helium*
    Weller M.K., Weinberg D.H., **Johnson J.W.**
    2024, MNRAS, 583, 1517 – 1534 arxiv:2404.08765

13. *Galactic Chemical Evolution Models Favor an Extended Type Ia Supernova Delay-Time Distribution*
    Dubay L.O., Johnson J.A., **Johnson J.W.**
    2024, ApJ, 973, 55 – 80 arxiv:2404.08059

14. *The APO-K2 Catalog. II. Accurate Stellar Ages for Red Giant Branch Stars Across the Milky Way*
    Warfield J.T., et al., incl. **Johnson J.W.**
    2024, AJ, 167, 208 – 231 arxiv:2403.03249

15. *Nature vs. Nurture: Distinguishing effects from stellar processing and chemical evolution on carbon and nitrogen in red giant stars*
    Roberts J.D., et al., incl. **Johnson J.W.**
    2024, MNRAS, 530, 149 – 166 arxiv:2403.03249

16. *The Scale of Stellar Yields: Implications of the Measured Mean Iron Yield of Core Collapse Supernovae*
    Weinberg D.H., Griffith E.J., **Johnson J.W.**, Thompson T.A.
    2023, ApJ, 973, 122 – 136 arxiv:2309.05719

17. *Untangling the Sources of Abundance Dispersion in Low-Metallicity Stars*
    Griffith E.J., Johnson J.A., Weinberg D.H., Ilyin I., **Johnson J.W.**, Rodriguez-Martinez R., Strassmeier K.G.
    2022, ApJ, 944, 47 – 67 arxiv:2210.01821

18. *Birth of the Galactic Disk Revealed by the H3 Survey*
Conroy C., et al., incl. **Johnson J.W.**
2022, submitted to AAS Journals, under peer review arxiv:2204.02989

19. *Primordial Helium-3 Redux: The Helium Isotope Ratio of the Orion Nebula*
Cooke R.J., Noterdaeme P., **Johnson J.W.**, Pettini M., Welsh L., Peroux C., Murphy M.T., Weinberg D.H.
2022, ApJ, 932, 60 – 76 arxiv:2203.11256

20. *Residual Abundances in GALAH DR3: Implications for Nucleosynthesis and Identification of Unique Stellar Populations*
Griffith E.J., Weinberg D.H., Buder S., Johnson J.A., **Johnson J.W.**, Vincenzo F.
2021, ApJ, 931, 23 – 50 arxiv: 2110.06240

21. *Chemical Cartography with APOGEE: Mapping Disk Populations with a Two-Process Model and Residual Abundances*
Weinberg D.H., et al., incl. **Johnson J.W.**
2021, ApJS, 260, 32 – 77 arxiv:2108.08860

22. *CNO dredge-up in a sample of APOGEE/Kepler red giants: Tests of stellar models and galactic evolutionary trends of N/O and C/N*
Vincenzo F., et al., incl. **Johnson J.W.**
2021, submitted to MNRAS, under peer review arxiv:2106.03912

23. *The Impact of Black Hole Formation on Population-averaged Supernova Yields*
Griffith E.J., Sukhbold T., Weinberg D.H., Johnson J.A., **Johnson J.W.**, Vincenzo F.
2021, ApJ, 921, 73 – 94 arxiv:2103.09837

24. *Nucleosynthesis signatures of neutrino-driven winds from proto-neutron stars: a perspective from chemical evolution models*
Vincenzo F., Thompson T.A., Weinberg D.H., Griffith E.J., **Johnson J.W.**, Johnson J.A.
2021, MNRAS, 508, 3499 – 3507 arxiv:2102.04920

25. *The Similarity of Abundance Ratio Trends and Nucleosynthetic Patterns in the Milky Way Disk and Bulge*
Griffith E.J., et al., incl. **Johnson J.W.**
2021, ApJ, 909, 77 – 101 arxiv:2009.05063